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Dickie Bird at 92: Letters, long walks and the love of cricket

From his 16th-century cottage to county matches in Scarborough, Bird's life remains rooted in **rhythm, cricket, and quiet purpose.**

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Some mornings feel unusually lazy and aimless for Dickie Bird.

There are days when he rises early, completes his exercises, and runs around the backyard garden. At other times, though, nothing feels quite right.

"I find no purpose in getting out of bed. There have been many such days," he says. "When I wake up and the first ray of the sun hits the curtains, I wonder if I even need to get up. What's the purpose?"

Eventually, the 92-year-old — who sometimes calls himself a 'young man' — does get up. He makes breakfast, steps out for a walk, or strolls to the front

gate of his 16th-century cottage to check the letterbox.

"Even now I get plenty of letters from all around the world," Bird says, as we sip our second round of 'full milk, no sugar' coffee at a plush hotel just a stone's throw from the sleepy Dodworth railway station.

Barnsley, where Bird was born and has lived all his life, is a half-hour's drive from here.

"Every time I come here, I drive myself. It's a nice little drive," he says, nodding toward his Jaguar—his long-time companion, made possible, he says, by "all those book sales." At one point, he considered hiring a chauffeur, but his doctors had other ideas.

"I told them, 'Are you sure I can continue driving?' and they said, 'You must...'"

So he did.

He doesn't use GPS; he knows most of the roads around Barnsley and Dodworth by heart. He isn't fond of smartphones either.

"I end up pressing random keys and dialling up wrong people," he

I have been doing it since the age of 14... even now, I read the newspapers and keep clippings of all the interesting stories and whatever they write about me.